Unit 4: Civilisation

# Project: A leaflet about an archaeological site

**Lesson 4-5**
Book pages 46-47

💡 **Big idea:** We look at **archaeological sites in Oman**, discuss **reliable ways to research** information, read a leaflet about the **Al Baleed Archaeological Park** in Salalah, and then make our own **information leaflet** about a site in Oman.

🎯 **I will learn:**
- Name archaeological sites in Oman
- Discuss methods of research and reliable sources
- Find information in a leaflet
- Plan and design an information leaflet

## 📖 Key words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **archaeological site**<br>موقع أثري | **leaflet**<br>نشرة / مطوية | **research**<br>بحث | **reliable**<br>موثوق |
| **excavate**<br>يُنقّب | **ruins**<br>أطلال / آثار | **World Heritage Site**<br>موقع تراث عالمي | **port**<br>ميناء |
| **attraction**<br>معلم جذب | | | |

### Ways to research

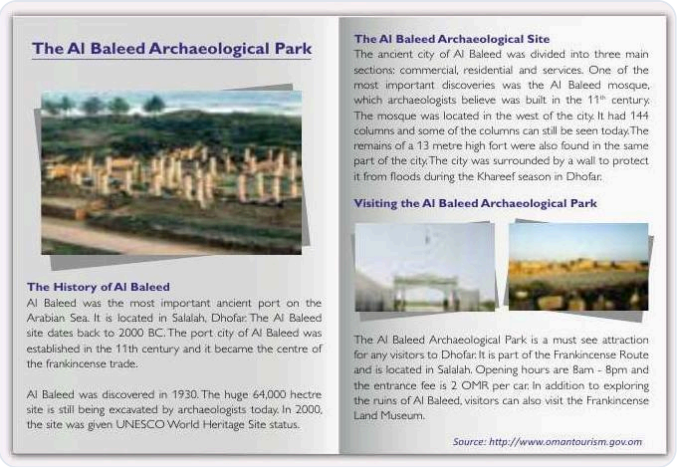
- Looking for information online or in a book
- Asking a history teacher
- Contacting the Ministry of Heritage and Culture
- Visiting the site or the national museum
- Use **reliable sources** because some information online is not correct

### Al Baleed Archaeological Park

- The most important ancient **port** on the Arabian Sea, in **Salalah, Dhofar**
- The site dates back to **2000 BC** and became a centre of the **frankincense trade**
- Discovered in **1930**, a huge 64,000-hectare site still being excavated
- In **2000** it became a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**
- Al Baleed mosque had **144 columns** and was built in the 11th century

### Plan your leaflet

- Which archaeological site?
- How will you research it?
- What information: history, the site, visiting times and prices
- Design: size, colours, images and layout



**The Al Baleed Archaeological Park**

**The History of Al Baleed**

Al Baleed was the most important ancient port on the Arabian Sea. It is located in Salalah, Dhofar. The Al Baleed site dates back to 2000 BC. The port city of Al Baleed was established in the 11th century and it became the centre of the frankincense trade.

Al Baleed was discovered in 1930. The huge 64,000 hectre site is still being excavated by archaeologists today. In 2000, the site was given UNESCO World Heritage Site status.

**The Al Baleed Archaeological Site**

The ancient city of Al Baleed was divided into three main sections: commercial, residential and services. One of the most important discoveries was the Al Baleed mosque, which archaeologists believe was built in the 11th century. The mosque was located in the west of the city. It had 144 columns and some of the columns can still be seen today. The remains of a 13 metre high fort were also found in the same part of the city. The city was surrounded by a wall to protect it from floods during the Khareef season in Dhofar.

**Visiting the Al Baleed Archaeological Park**

The Al Baleed Archaeological Park is a must see attraction for any visitors to Dhofar. It is part of the Frankincense Route and is located in Salalah. Opening hours are 8am - 8pm and the entrance fee is 2 OMR per car. In addition to exploring the ruins of Al Baleed, visitors can also visit the Frankincense Land Museum.

*Source: http://www.omantourism.gov.om*

Leaflet: Al Baleed Archaeological Park

## ✏️ Examples

**Which source is more reliable: a random website or the Ministry of Heritage and Culture?**

**Answer: The Ministry, because it is an official source.**

**When did Al Baleed become a World Heritage Site?**

**Answer: In 2000**

**Write a heading for a leaflet about Bahla Fort**

**Answer: Bahla Fort: A Treasure of Omani History**

### ⭐ Remember

- A good leaflet has a clear title, short sections with headings, pictures and visitor information
- Check facts in two sources

### ⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ All websites are reliable. ✓ Check the source of information
- ✗ Al Baleed is in Muscat. ✓ Al Baleed is in Salalah, Dhofar

🧩 **Activity:** Make an information leaflet about an archaeological site in Oman

### ✅ Check yourself

1. Where is Al Baleed?
2. What trade made it famous?
3. How many columns did the mosque have?

Answers: (1) Salalah, Dhofar ، (2) frankincense ، (3) 144